

```
filetovalidate = ConfigParser.ConfigParser()
filetovalidate.read(filetobevalidated)

incorrectlines = []
for section in filetovalidate.sections():
#check each key is present in corresponding golden section
for key in filetovalidate.options(section):
if not goldenconfig.has_option(section, key):
incorrectlines.append(key + '=' + filetovalidate.
get(section, key))
# print incorrect lines
if len(incorrectlines) > 0 :
print 'The following lines are incorrect'
for k in incorrectlines: print k
else: print 'All keys are fine'
return incorrectlines
```



Note: Single line comments can be made using #

Invoking the same using the Python interpreter

We can invoke the same using the Python interpreter. Before you do that though, make sure the Python path is added into the PATH variable.

```
C:\Users\ktrichy>python "C:\ValidateConfigFile.py"
invoking ValidateConfigFile('validfile', 'validfile')
All keys are fine
```

So, what have we accomplished so far? We started with a quick introduction to why someone should be interested in

using Python. The answer we have suggested in this column is that Python could act as an ally to an existing program or product, and helps to solve small issues so that the main product can function properly.

One problem that could be tormenting products is 'incorrect configuration files'. So we looked at the format of a configuration file, represented by a .cfg extension, and how Python provides a ConfigParser package to parse such files. We then looked at the interface offered by this class and what should be of interest to solve such a problem, before introducing elements of a small function that would validate a config file against a properly formed reference file, called a golden file in this article. Along the way, we also got introduced to IDLE (Python GUI) and how it makes debugging a lot easier. We saw examples of such debugging outputs, before we put together the whole solution and ran it across the Python interpreter.

This article is the first in a series to help you kick start what could prove to be a lifelong interest in Python. If you liked what you've read so far, you can be sure there are more such articles in the pipeline exploring the power and flexibility of Python. 

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